

Jiayi Zhu

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Education

University of Florida, Gainesville, FL

B.A. in Economics; completing requirements for B.S. in Data Science, expected May 2027

- GPA: 3.95
- Relevant Coursework: Probability Theory and Stochastic Processes, Statistics Theory, Regression Analysis, Game Theory, Programming with Data in R, Programming Fundamentals 1&2, Reasoning and Proof in Mathematics

Experience

Lab Assistant, Disasters, Trust & Social Change

2023 Aug - Present

- Support community-based disaster research projects examining environmental health, housing inequality, and disaster recovery in Florida communities.
- Prepare research fair materials, draft public-facing research summaries, and support content for community-engaged research projects.
- Conduct interviews and distribute surveys for an indoor air quality study while supporting fieldwork related to hurricane recovery efforts in Cedar Key and Tampa.

Data Analyst, ComDisp Belmont Project

2026 Jan - Present

- Contribute to a Belmont Forum-supported international research project investigating housing-related health disparities exacerbated by climate change across case sites including Turkey, the United States, and Vietnam.
- Participate in biweekly research meetings with an interdisciplinary team, supporting project planning, literature synthesis, and discussion of cross-country research design.
- Trained in agent-based modeling (ABM) to examine how household-level behaviors, housing conditions, and environmental factors may interact to produce unequal health outcomes.

Researcher, 2026 Natural Hazards Center Summer Workshop

2026 May - June

- Contributed to a community-centered environmental health research poster analyzing spatial and housing-related risk factors in Jacksonville's Health Zone 1.
- Integrated survey evidence, indoor air quality monitoring, and spatial hazard data to examine links between housing infrastructure, environmental exposure, and health disparities.
- Applied participatory research methods to connect data analysis with community-driven policy recommendations on indoor air quality and housing equity.

Researcher, 2024 Natural Hazards Center Summer Workshop

2024 May - June

- Conducted research on overlooked coastal debris in Florida, including gas tanks, furniture, and other non-plastic waste categories identified through Cedar Key fieldwork.
- Analyzed 10 years of Florida coastal cleanup data from the Ocean Conservancy database, categorizing debris into six groups and assessing environmental risks.

- Developed poster findings presented at the Natural Hazards Center Summer Workshop, highlighting gaps in coastal debris monitoring and disaster recovery research.

Team Leader & Individual Researcher, Capstone Project

2024 July - Oct

- Led a group of three students, coordinating with instructors and completing assignments on our topic, “The Influences of Unequal Economic Development Between Rural and Urban Areas on Health Service Choice”
- Used a mixed methods approach to analyze various socioeconomic factors such as unequal Medicare policies, income differences, and cultural disparities
- Completed a capstone research paper on rural-urban health inequality in China, contributing to problem framing and factor analysis.
- Writing sample available upon request.

Research / Case Analysis Intern, Harvard Center Shanghai

2024 June

- Trained in writing business case analyses, combining solid data with objective narratives
- 1st Project: Focused on investigating the Chinese soft drink industry, analyzing market trends and strategies
- 2nd Project: researched the case study on Master Kong, detailing its development and challenges
- Volunteered at an alumni event when the Dean of Harvard Business, Dr. Srikant Datar, visited Shanghai, supporting logistics and gaining industry insights
- Writing sample available upon request.

Volunteer, Cedar Key Coastal Area Cleanup

2024 Oct - Present

- Contributed to two distinct cleanup initiatives: one organized annually by the Ocean Conservancy, which focuses on recording detailed data on coastal trash, and another led by our school in response to Hurricane Helene and Milton
- Coordinated a cleanup effort in Cedar Key County, one of the hardest-hit areas, where most local houses and infrastructures were devastated
- Participated as a volunteer for coastal trash removal and worked to clear debris, including damaged furniture and building materials, transporting them to disposal sites along the roads

Honors & Awards

- National Economics Challenge, Regional Microeconomics Individual Distinction Award, 2022
- National Economics Challenge, Regional Top Scoring Team in Macroeconomics, 2021
- The Honorable Mention Award, Youth Observation Contest, 2020

Skills

- Programming & Data Analysis: Python, R, C++ basics
- Statistical Methods: regression analysis, probability, statistical inference, survey data analysis
- Research Methods: literature review, survey distribution, interview support, fieldwork, participatory action research
- Modeling: agent-based modeling, Markov chain modeling
- Languages: Mandarin Chinese, English